Africa

The world's second largest continent, Africa is rich in history, language, culture, and geographic diversity. With a stunning collection of animals, reptiles, birds, and insects, it is also where human beings first appeared on Earth.

PYRAMIDS AT GIZA

During the 4th Dynasty (2613–2494 BCE), Giza became a royal burial ground for the Ancient Egyptians. Three pyramid complexes serve as tombs for their dead kings. The Sphinx was added to guard the pyramids, and each king's royal family and courts were buried nearby.

THE SPHINX
The Sphinx is modelled on a mythical animal with the head of a human and the body of a lion.

BUILDING BLOCKS
The construction methods of the Pyramids are unknown. More than 2 million blocks of stone were used just to make the largest, the Great Pyramid.

SAHARA DESERT

The Sahara covers much of North Africa and is the world's largest hot desert. Constantly shaped by the wind, around 25 per cent of the desert is sand dunes. The rest is made up of a barren, rocky landscape with very little water. The highest peak is Emi Koussi (3,145 m/ 11,294 ft) in the Tibesti Mountains.

SAHARA TRANSPORT
Camels' feet allow them to move quickly and easily through sand. Camels can last up to 17 days without food or water.

FAST FACTS

Africa makes up around 20 per cent of Earth's land mass. It contains the world's longest river – the Nile.

- **AREA:** 30,335,000 sq km (11,712,434 sq miles)
- **POPULATION:** 1,136,239,000
- **NUMBER OF COUNTRIES:** 54
- **LARGEST COUNTRY:** Algeria 2,381,741 sq km (919,595 sq miles)
- **LARGEST COUNTRY BY POPULATION:** Nigeria 177,155,754
- **LARGEST CITY BY POPULATION:** Lagos, Nigeria 21,000,000
- **HIGHEST POINT:** Mount Kilimanjaro, Tanzania 5,895 m (19,336 ft)
- **LONGEST RIVER:** Nile River 6,695 km (4,160 miles)
- **LARGEST LAKE:** Lake Victoria, Uganda, Kenya, Tanzania 68,880 sq km (26,560 sq miles)

KEY

ELEVATION
4,000 m
2,000 m
1,000 m
500 m
250 m
100 m
Below sea level
Sea level
250 m
2,000 m
4,000 m
Mountain
Lowest point

POPULATION
Capital city
Over 1 million
500,000 to 1 million
100,000 to 500,000
below 100,000